

Diabetic Friendly Foods

Low Glycemic Index Choices

Diabetes is a condition where the body has difficulty regulating blood sugar. Choosing foods with a low glycemic index (GI) helps keep blood sugar levels steady. Low GI foods are digested slowly, leading to a gradual rise in blood sugar rather than a sharp spike.

Understanding the Glycemic Index

The glycemic index ranks carbohydrates on a scale of 0 to 100 based on how quickly they raise blood sugar. Low GI foods are 55 or less. Medium GI foods are 56 to 69. High GI foods are 70 or more. Combining high GI foods with protein, fat, or fiber can lower the overall glycemic response.

Recommended Food Choices

Whole grains, legumes, most fruits, non-starchy vegetables, and nuts generally have a low glycemic index. These are useful choices for people managing blood sugar. Refined carbohydrates and sugary foods have a higher GI and should be limited.

Suggested Items:

- Whole grains like oats, brown rice, and barley
- Legumes including lentils, chickpeas, and beans
- Most fresh fruits, especially apples, pears, and berries
- Non-starchy vegetables like spinach, broccoli, and capsicum
- Nuts and seeds as snacks
- Curd and milk in moderate portions

Reference Table

Food	GI (approx.)	Serving
Oats (rolled)	55	1 cup
Lentils	30	1 cup
Apple	38	1 medium
Brown rice	50	1 cup
Chickpeas	28	1 cup

Conclusion

Portion size matters even with low GI foods. Eating balanced meals that include protein, fiber, and healthy fats supports steady blood sugar levels.